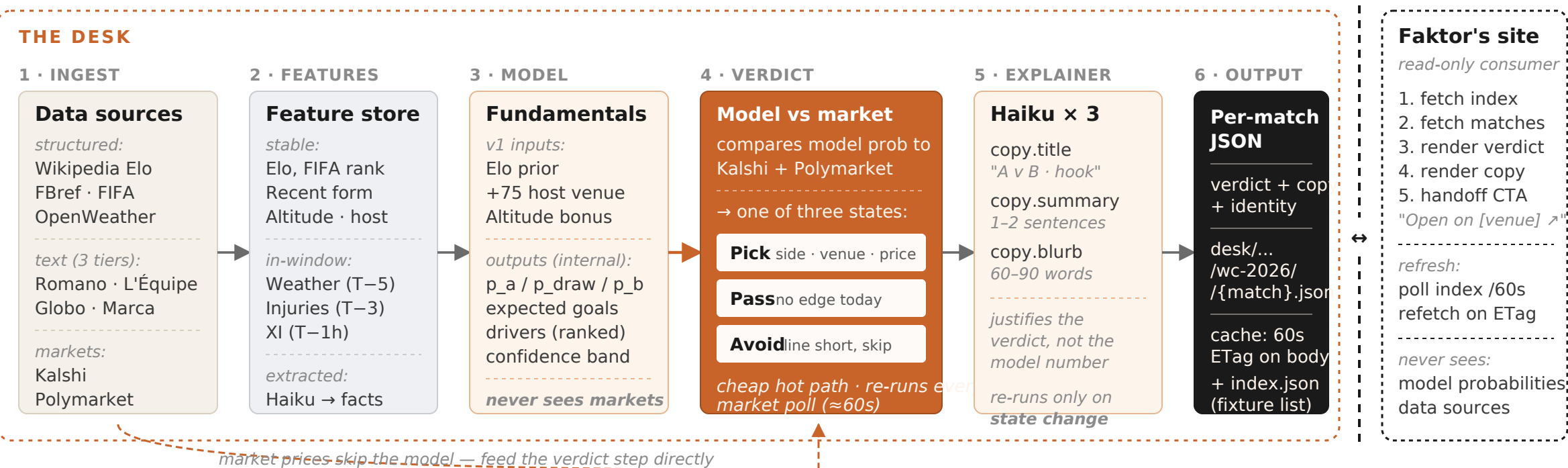


The Desk — engine architecture & output contract

Black-box service for Odds Primer. Faktor consumes a slim JSON contract: verdict + copy. Model internals stay inside.

Pipeline · everything inside the dashed border is The Desk



Output contract · what each match JSON looks like

```
{
  "match_id" : "wc26-d-fra-mex-20260612" ,
  "kickoff_utc" : "2026-06-12T19:00:00Z" ,
  "group" : "D",
  "team_a" : "France" , "team_b" : "Mexico" ,
  "venue" : { "city" : "Guadalajara" , "stadium" : "Estadio Akron" , "country" : "MX"},
  // the call
  "verdict" : {
    "state" : "pick" , // "pick" | "pass" | "avoid"
    "side" : "France" , // team name | "draw" | null
    "market_venue": "polymarket" , // "kalshi" | "polymarket" | null
    "price" : "-180" , // American odds for now
    "edge_pp": 4.2 // gap to market in pp
  },
  // the editorial — render verbatim, do not interpolate
  "copy": { "title" , "summary", "blurb", "citations" : [...] },
  "updated_at" : "2026-06-12T17:00:00Z"
```

The three verdict states

Pick *we see an edge*

side, market_venue, price, edge_pp all set.
UI: full verdict block + venue CTA.

e.g. Back France on Polymarket at -180

Pass *no edge today*
side, market_venue, price all null.
UI: "no edge" block, no CTA, no link.
e.g. Tunisia v Australia · markets agree

Avoid *negative signal*
side, market_venue, price all null.
UI: "skip" block, no link. Named opinion.
e.g. Skip Germany v Japan · line short

Refresh cadence · three speeds in The Desk

Model — weekly · daily T-5 · hourly T-3 **Verdict** — every market poll (≈60s) **Explainer** — only on verdict-state change

Faktor doesn't track which speed updated — just polls index.json /60s and refetches whatever's changed via ETag.

